



EUCAST

European Committee
on Antimicrobial
Susceptibility Testing

Anti-Fungal Susceptibility
Testing
Subcommittee

Guidance on how to qualify in-house performance of commercial tests for antifungal susceptibility testing before adoption of EUCAST breakpoints

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Before implementing a commercial test, it is essential to confirm that it aligns with the reference method from which the clinical breakpoints are derived.

If you intend to apply EUCAST breakpoints, you must ensure that the results obtained with the commercial test accurately reflect those obtained with EUCAST reference microdilution methods. This verification can be carried out as follows:

a) Run the EUCAST QC strains, ten times each, and check whether the most common MIC (the mode) corresponds to the target MIC for each QC strain, and that all MICs fall within the defined range (see [EUCAST QC tables](#)). Random variation is acceptable (a maximum of one MIC value out of ten may fall outside the range), but systematic deviation (the mode consistently lying to one side of the target) is not. A systematic deviation indicates that EUCAST breakpoints will not be applicable and requires further investigation (e.g. concentrations, plasticware or endpoint reading). In cases of random variation where more than one MIC is outside the range, repeat the procedure with a further ten tests, allowing one of these ten to fall outside the range.

b) If the QC strain results agree with the EUCAST QC targets and ranges, proceed to a confirmatory study with the following unrelated clinical isolates:

- 10 *Candida albicans*
- 10 *Candida auris* (*Candidozyma auris*)
- 10 *Candida glabrata* (*Nakaseomyces glabratus*)
- 10 *Candida tropicalis*
- 10 *Candida parapsilosis*
- 10 *Candida krusei* (*Pichia kudriavzevii*)
- 10 *Aspergillus fumigatus*
- 10 *Aspergillus flavus*

Check that the mode of each distribution is within ± 1 dilution of the mode for the corresponding drug–organism combination, as defined in the EUCAST rationale documents ([see here](#)). If this condition is met, the test can probably be run reliably, and EUCAST breakpoints may be adopted. If not, the method will misclassify isolates.

c) Ideally, a final test should include known resistant mutants with both low-grade and high-grade resistance to each of the antifungal agents included the routine testing, to ensure correct performance in detecting resistance.

d) In countries where species other than the recommended above present important clinical challenges, it may be appropriate to include such species in the clinical isolate study (point b).